

■ EVIDENCE LAYER

THE COLLECTIVE

A living evidence layer for public reality.

Public records tell us what institutions claim. The Collective helps communities document what actually happens on the ground.

Governments publish records. Reality happens on site.

A project can have a budget, a contractor, and a "completed" stamp in official records—without physically existing.

THE SIMPLE QUESTION

“Was this clinic actually built?”

The answer is locked in PDF audits, budget tables, gazette notices, and local memory.

Manual and Painful

Verification requires weeks of legal and journalistic labor.

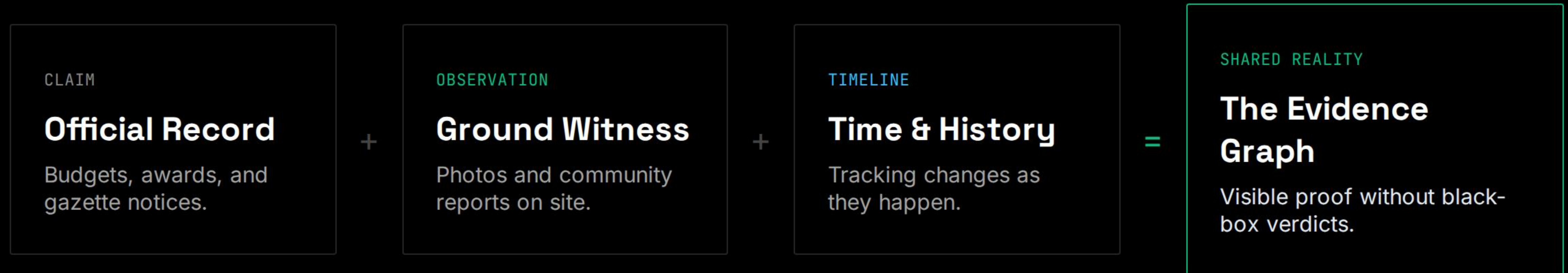
Missing Connective Tissue

The data exists. The live connection does not.

Paper reports are treated as fact rather than claims needing verification.

Don't ask AI to decide truth. Make it connect evidence.

Official reports are claims. Photos are observations. Neither is automatically the final verdict.



Claims + Observations + Evidence + Time → Shared Public Picture

Continuous inspection for public projects & services.

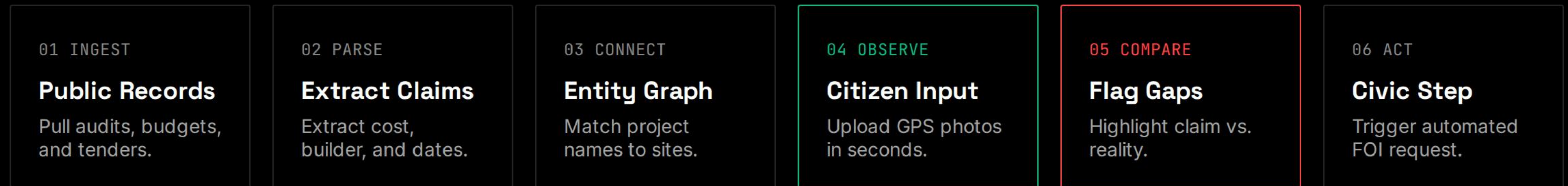
Every project follows a live 5-phase evidence trajectory from commitment to delivery:



Trigger Question: "What specific evidence would resolve this uncertainty?"

From PDF files to ground verification.

Six direct stages turn government paperwork into live community oversight:



Every source preserves document links and timestamps.

Lucky Summer, Ruaraka

Construction of Lucky Summer Dispensary

■ verified

Current picture: The record consistently indicates the project was not delivered.

Timeline

Step 1 of 5

28 Sept 2023 implementation

OAG field inspection (28–29 Sept 2023): Lucky Summer Dispensary had barely started and the building is dilapidated.

"Field inspection on these projects carried out on September 28 and 29, 2023 revealed they were not complete... the Lucky Summer Dispensary barely started and the building is dilapidated" – Page 1

Office of the Auditor-General / [Report of the Auditor-General on County Executives FY2022/2023 \(Green Book\) - Nairobi City County](#)

One observation can be flawed. A swarm reveals truth.

The Collective never asks citizens to vote on truth. It asks them to observe from a strict taxonomy.

ADD AN OBSERVATION

Tell us what you saw at this site.

Open and working

People are using the facility

Partly built

The building is not finished

Work stopped

Construction has stopped or the site is locked

Abandoned

The site is overgrown or left unused

Not started

Nothing has been built yet

THE OUTCOME

Direct Micro-Observations

Truth is not a popularity contest. Sentiments cannot confirm whether an electrical transformer or clinic wing physically operates. Standardized observation taxonomy separates noise from structural facts.

Trust is not a score. It is inspectability.

The Collective separates evidence tiers so anyone can see the basis of every assertion:

TIER 1

What Was Claimed

Quotes and links to original gazette files.

TIER 2

What Was Observed

Timestamped photo uploads and GPS points.

TIER 3

What Is Supported

Facts backed by multiple independent sources.

TIER 4

What Is Unknown

Open questions and unbuilt sections.

Core Rule: When evidence conflicts, the system shows it openly instead of faking consensus.

AI handles what humans cannot do at scale.

Automating the repetitive manual work of reading and connecting thousands of PDF records:

PDF Extraction

Converts scans and budget tables into structured claims.

Entity Resolution

Matches slightly different project names to identical sites.

Timeline Reasoning

Traces money and completion dates across multiple fiscal years.

Evidence Linking

Connects photos straight to specific tender line items.

Conflict Detection

Flags contradictions between government status and ground photos.

Inquiry Prompts

Specifies the exact missing document needed to resolve the case.

AI powers the heavy research: expanding community capacity instead of replacing human oversight.

From passive spectators to active monitors.

Removing friction between noticing a problem and taking immediate civic action:

WHAT CITIZENS SEE

What happened?

A simple timeline assembled from reports and photos.

What does the state claim?

The exact audit records, linked in one click.

Where is the conflict?

Clear discrepancies without legal jargon.

ACTION PATHWAY

“What can I do right now?”

Verify: Snap an on-site photo in 10 seconds.

Request: Send a pre-filled Access to Information request.

Report: Escalate stalled projects to local ward groups.

Turning uncertainty into organized civic response.

From 2-year post-mortems to real-time oversight.

Catching stalled projects while money is being spent, not years after it disappears:

LEGACY AUDITING

Post-Mortem Reports

Auditor-General reviews arrive 24 months later. Court cases drag for years. Funds are already gone.

TOO LATE TO SAVE FUNDS

THE COLLECTIVE

Continuous Evidence Stream

Ongoing community check-ins between initial award and completion, catching stalls immediately.

INTERVENE IN REAL TIME

Built in Kenya. Works anywhere with public funds.

The system relies on universal building blocks that deploy in any country:

STARTING PILOT

Nairobi Clinics & Roads

Tracking Nairobi County Green Book records, Ward CDF allocations, and Kenya Open Data.

UNIVERSAL CORE PRIMITIVES

Institution

Project

Claim

Source

Observation

Evidence

Geo/Time

Only local portals change. The verification architecture remains completely identical.

Public records are digitized. Public trust is not.

More data alone doesn't create accountability without verification:

10x

More Portal Uploads

More PDFs and records are uploaded than ever before, but sheer document volume doesn't guarantee truth.

Now

Multimodal LLMs + Vision

Extracting complex claims from PDF tables and matching them to ground photos can now be done at pennies.

Value for everyone in the civic ecosystem.

Measurable benefits for four key stakeholder groups:

CITIZENS

Ward Clarity

Know what was funded in your ward and submit quick on-site photos.

CIVIL SOCIETY

Targeted Oversight

Cut hundreds of manual hours; spot repeat contractor defaults immediately.

JOURNALISTS

Verified Trails

Go from anonymous tips to citation-backed timelines with dates.

INSTITUTIONS

Defensible Records

Prove project delivery with visible community ground verification.

COLLECTIVE

PUBLIC REALITY SYSTEM

Public records are only useful when communities can verify them.

Observe. Connect. Verify. Act.

OSF × Andela Information You Can Trust Hackathon

Track: Transparency & Accountability